

as a way to 'skin' your player.

The most exciting feature about CMus is the wide range of support for various codecs. It can play Ogg Vorbis, FLAC, MP3 (with *libmad*), WAV, AAC or WMA—i.e., almost every major format available these days. Moreover, it also supports almost every output plug-in—OSS, ALSA, *libao*, ARTS, SUN, and also WaveOut on Windows.

Using CMus

Using CMus is not very difficult if you already know or use vi(m). Let's start by adding some music to the library (yes, library—more on that later). Just type in the following command:

```
add PATH
```

...and you will see a list of all the subdirectories and music files in the main window. If you haven't changed the keybindings yet, then, by default, you can use space to open the directory tree to list subdirectories. The files will be listed in the left side pane (refer to Figure 1). You can move between the two panes using the tab. Some more basic commands are listed below:

- `:clear` will clear the playlist
- `:save ~/playlist_name.pls` will save the current playlist into `playlist_name.pls` inside your home directory
- `:load playlist_name.pls` will load `playlist_name.pls`
- `:set softvol=true` will enable software volume control

The player supports five views and two option windows.

The default window is at 1. If you press the numbers from 1 to 7, you will cycle through all the seven modes, which are:

1. **Library view** (key 1) is also the default view mode. It includes an artist/album tree, with albums sorted by year
2. **Sorted library view** (key 2) provides a simple, common playlist view with custom sorting
3. **Playlist view** (key 3) is an editable playlist
4. **Play queue view** (key 4) displays a queue of tracks
5. **File browser** (key 5) is a directory browser
6. **Filters view** (key 6) is a list of user-defined filters
7. **Settings view** (key 7) displays keybindings and options

As in the case of vi(m), you can start searching by using the / (slash) operator; pressing N brings the next search result. You can change the keybindings according to your preference. Copy the `rc` file from `/usr/share/cmus/` to `~/cmus/`. Make the changes according to your preference to get the keybindings you want. On the other hand, you can achieve the same from the view 7 (Settings view). Just hit `Enter` after highlighting the option you want to change. It will appear in the command line. You can then make the changes and hit `Enter` to save them.

The library in the player, which you can see in the Settings view at the bottom of the page, allows you to either play the entire library (i.e., the music files you added using `:add`) or the playlist you have. Once added, the music tracks will be persistent and are only removed

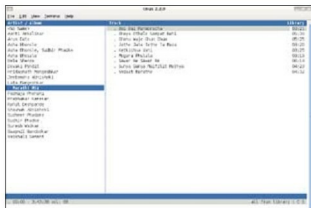


Figure 1: The CMus music player



Figure 2: Music library

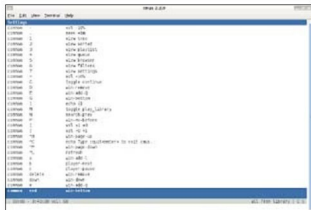


Figure 3: Key bindings

when you select them (*Space* in view 1/2) and press *Delete*. Once you have selected the songs, you can press *y* to add the songs to the playlist or *e/E* to add it to the end/start of the queue. You can also save/load the playlists as mentioned above.

Colouring

CMus also allows users to change the colour of the player windows and borders. In view 7 (the Settings view), you can view the current settings for the colour scheme. If you want to change a value, make your